

**Downpatrick Family of Parishes
Parishes of Saul & Ballee and Kilclief**

**Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time
Sunday 6th September 2026**

Mass Schedule for the coming week:

Date	St Patrick's Saul	Stella Maris Strangford	St Joseph's Ballycruttle	St Malachy's Kilclief	St Tassach's Carlin
Sunday 6 th Sept	9.30am		12noon	11am	
Monday 7 th Sept	10am	7.30pm			
Tuesday 8 th Sept	10am				
Weds 9 th Sept	10am				
Thursday 10 th Sept					
Friday 11 th Sept	7pm			9.30am	
Saturday 12 th Sept	5pm	6.30pm			
Sunday 13 th Sept	9.30am			11am	12noon

Masses are available to view online at www.saulandballeeparish.com and www.churchmedia.tv

Eucharistic Adoration in St Patrick's Church, Saul each Tuesday after 10am Mass concluding at 8pm. Holy Hour from 2-3pm

Our Lady of Knock Novena each Monday evening in Stella Maris, Strangford at 7.10pm.

The Sanctuary Lamp in St Patrick's Church, Saul has been lit for private intentions. If you would like it lit for your intentions please contact the Parish office. The cost is £5 per week.

Eucharistic Adoration

Down & Connor Diocese is renewing and developing its *Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee* in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in Parishes throughout the Diocese. You are welcome to attend an information meeting on Friday 2nd October in St Patrick's Centre, Downpatrick at 8pm. Registration from 7.30pm. Please see the poster in the Churches for further details.

We invite you all to join us for a cup of tea and biscuits after 7pm Mass on Friday 11th September in St Patrick's PS, Saul to celebrate Fr Aidans 40th Anniversary of his Ordination to the Priesthood.

Start of School Term Masses will be celebrated as follows:-

St Patrick's PS, Saul on Monday 7th September at 10am

St Malachy's PS, Kilclief on Friday 11th September at 9.30am

Recently Deceased: John Lundy

Parish of Saul & Ballee

Anniversary Masses

Saturday 5th September – Kenny Kelly, Thomas & Elizabeth McCormick

Sunday 6th September – Michael Burns (12noon)

Wednesday 9th September – Spencer Cusack

Friday 11th September – Niall Laverty

Saturday 12th September – James Hynds

Sunday 13th September – Raymond Blaney (12noon)

Saturday 19th September -Dermot Vint

Sunday 20th September – Patrick Grant (12noon)

Parish of Kilclief

Anniversary Masses

Saturday 5th September – Jason Hynds

Sunday 13th September – Kevin Cultra, Seamus McMorrow, Mary Polley, Patrick King

Saturday 19th September – Anna & William Shields

	Saul & Ballee	Kilclief
Weekly Collection	£1,822.20	£

Hymns – St Malachy's, Kilclief

Entrance: 348v1 Praise to the Lord

Offertory: 183v1 I am the bread of life

Communion: 466v1, 2 You shall cross the barren desert

Recessional: 175v1 Go to the Mass is ended

Hymns - St Patrick's, Saul

Entrance – 240 Do not be afraid

Offertory – 256 Fill my house

Communion – 165 Be still for the presence of the Lord

Recessional – 330 He's got the whole world in his hands

Legion of Mary Annual Trip to Knock will take place on Sunday 27th September. The cost is £30 per person, making the usual stops for breaks. Pick up points are at the following Churches:-

Newcastle – (back of the Church) 6.15am, Castlewellan – 6.30am, Downpatrick – 6.45am, Crossgar – 7am and Saintfield – 7.15am

To book your place you can place your money in an envelope along with your name and phone number and drop it into the Parish offices in Saul or Downpatrick (Patrician Youth Centre) or you can phone Geraldine on 07845 422723

IT COULD BE YOU!!!

I am deeply indebted to all the volunteers we have in our 2 Parishes. In fact, we could not function without each of you.

One of the biggest fears that prevent people from volunteering is that they could still be there in 15 years time!!

I don't want that for anyone which is why I am making this appeal.

We are always looking for new volunteers –

- For practical things such as cleaning our churches, helping with the flowers, collectors and counters.
- For the roles of Eucharistic Minister or readers, especially from the younger members of our congregations.
- For the various committees in the Parishes, I can assure you we try to keep the meetings brief and not too often.

If you would be interested, I'd love to hear from you – even to explain what the various roles entail. I am eager to revamp our Parish Pastoral Councils. To look at what can be done to make our Parishes and our celebrations more vibrant and meaningful.

Thank you all for your continued support.

Fr Aidan

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach - a Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Day Retreat to Lough Derg on Saturday 19th September. Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs..

MYMY is an accredited counselling service for adults based in Newcastle. If you or someone you know could benefit from counselling please give us call on 028 4372 7549, email hello@mymy.org.uk or self-refer via our website."

St Joseph Men's Camino - *Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.* Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2025–2026 programme begins on Wednesday 1st October and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away.

To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.



Opening Mass for the Season of Creation - 6.00 pm on Sunday 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". 1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (*Is* 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

SAFEGUARDING - If you have a concern, suspicion, or wish to make an allegation of child abuse, or abuse in relation to an adult at risk, please contact the Diocesan Safeguarding Office: Philip O'Hara, Designated Liaison Person, 120, Cliftonville Road, Belfast BT14 6LA. Mobile: 07534 992124 or Telephone: 028 90 492798. Email: philip.ohara@soddc.org or visit <https://downandconnorsafeguarding.com>

Very Rev Fr Aidan Brankin, Parish Priest 02844 612525 (Saul) or 02844 260101 (Strangford)

Saul Office: 02844 612525, Office Hours: Mon to Fri 9.30am to 12noon 10 St Patrick's Rd, Downpatrick, BT30 7JG

Kilclief Office: 02844260101 Office Hours: Monday 1pm to 3pm 8 Shore Rd, Strangford, BT30 7NL

Website: www.saulandballeeparish.com

Email: saul@downandconnor.org strangfordandkilclief@downandconnor.org